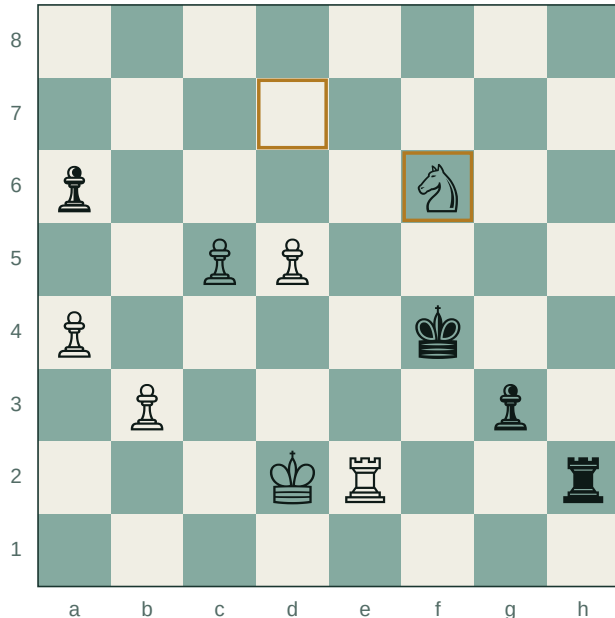


# Promotion combinations: Black, move 49

Promotion combinations

Black to move



Previous move: 49.Nf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**49...Kf3 50. Rxh2 gxh2 51. c6 h1=Q**

**49...Kf3** The king moves from f4 to f3. Recorded reply: **50.Rxh2**.

**50...gxh2** The pawn captures the rook on h2. Recorded reply: **51.c6**.

**51...h1=Q** The pawn moves from h2 to h1. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from -5 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on d2. Absolute pin: rook on e2.